

Basic Terminologies:

Below are some important **FortiADC terminologies** that can help you better understand how FortiADC works.

Real Servers:

These are the actual physical or virtual servers that provide the application or service. The **FortiADC** directs traffic to these servers based on load balancing rules. If you're running a website, the real servers would be the actual web servers hosting your site.

Server Pools:

A **server pool** is a group of **real servers** that share the responsibility of handling incoming traffic. FortiADC distributes traffic among all servers in the pool to ensure an even load and high availability.

For a web application, you might have multiple real servers running the same website. These servers would be grouped into a server pool, and FortiADC would decide which server in the pool should handle each incoming request.

Virtual Servers:

A virtual server is a logical entity created by FortiADC that represents the frontend of a service. Clients connect to the virtual server, and FortiADC then directs the traffic to the appropriate real server from the server pool.

A virtual server could be the IP address or domain name that clients use to connect to the application. The virtual server acts as the entry point for client requests.

Clients:

Clients are the devices or users who are requesting access to the services provided by the servers. These can be end-users accessing a website, applications, or services via their browsers or devices. The users visiting www.example.com on their computers or mobile phones are the clients.

Local Load Balancing:

Local load balancing refers to distributing traffic across servers within a single data center or network location.

Global Server Load Balancing (GSLB):

A technique to distribute traffic across multiple data centers in different geographical locations, optimizing performance and availability for users worldwide.

Health Checks:

FortiADC continuously monitors the health of servers in a pool to ensure that traffic is only directed to healthy servers. If a server fails the health check, FortiADC reroutes traffic to other operational servers.

Service:

A service is a program or function that runs on a computer or network to perform specific tasks. Services help devices, applications, and users communicate and work properly. Services can be public available to users over the internet or private used only within a local network. For example, **Web Service**, **FTP Service**, **Email Service** and **Database Service**.

